



Enhancing Segmented

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Neutrino 2026 [Ur

g Angular Sensi d Antineutrino I

for Reactor Monitoring

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[University of California at Irvine / June 22-

Sensitivity of Detectors

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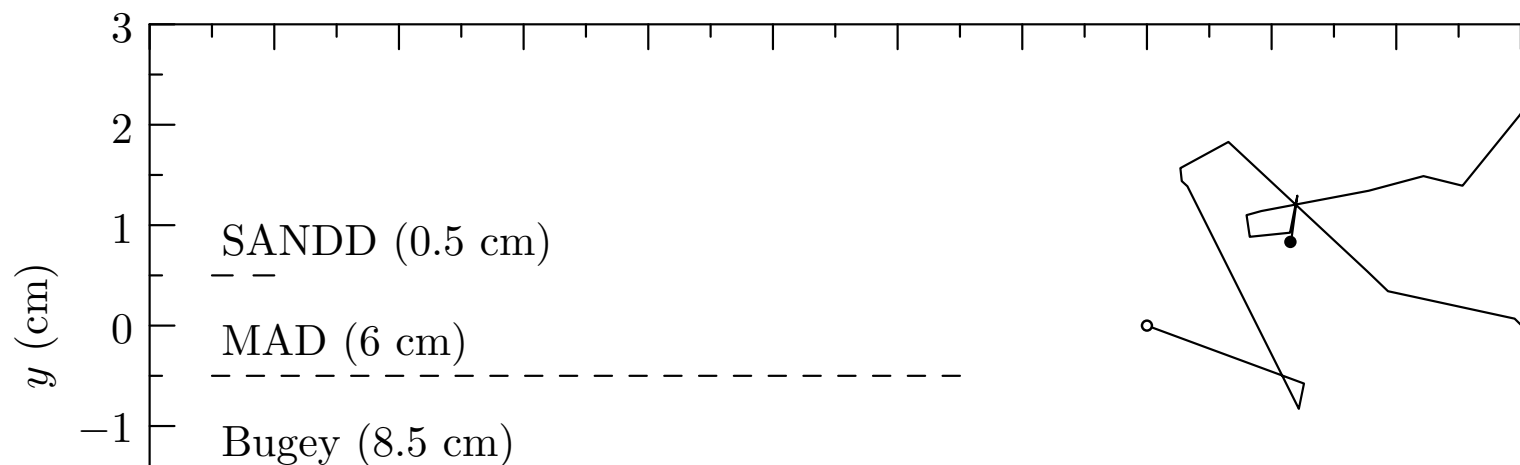
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22–26, 2026]



Localization of IBD Source

- Directional method for segmented Inverse Beta Decay
- Positron (e^+) gets most of the energy, and annihilates
- Neutron (1n) gets momentum direction, and captures
- Lithium 6 dopant localizes 1n capture with ^3_1H and ^4_2He
 $\sim 10 \mu\text{m}$ of capture
- direction to source inferred from 1n direction with e



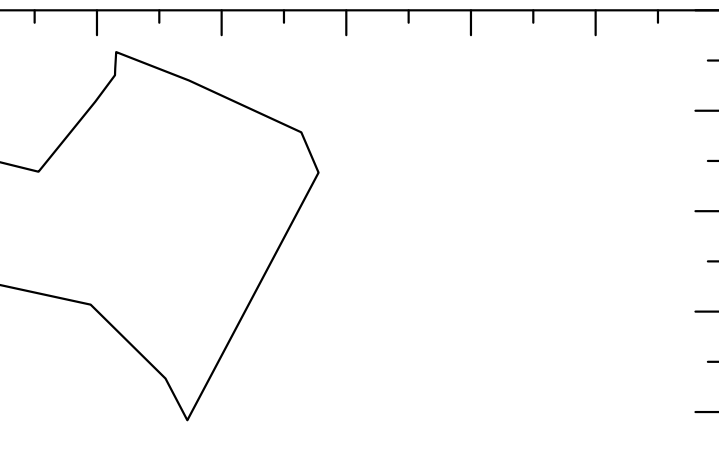
Decay (IBD) detectors

imulation marks prompt vertex

ture marks delayed vertex

and ${}^4_2\text{He}$ depositing energy within

th enough events



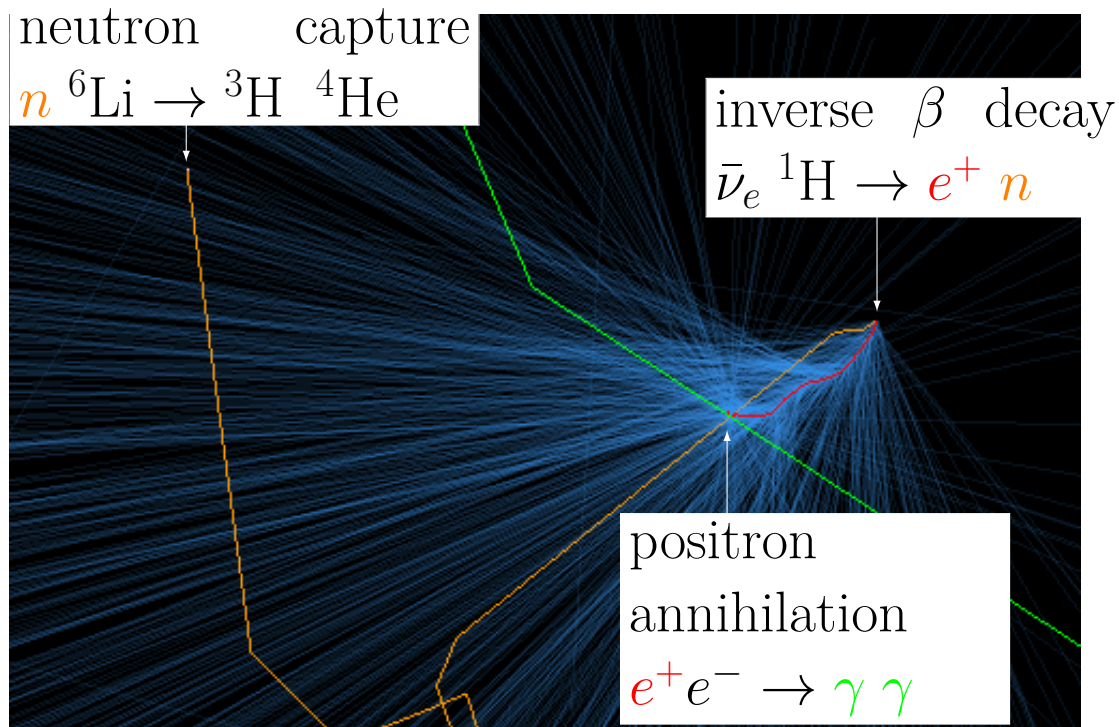
Our Approach

- Used RATPAC-2
- Created simple model
- Created grid over
segment sizes in a

Approach to Simulation Design

-2 for all simulations

monolithic geometry using 0.1%-wt ^6Li -doped plastic scint
overlay to create binning matrices for 5 mm, 50 mm and 15
analysis work



scintillator
150 mm

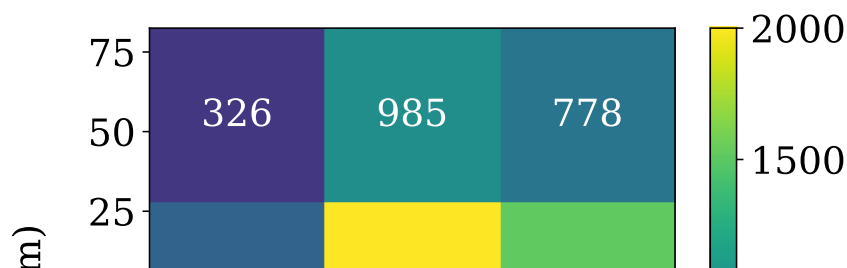
★ Conclusions, Findings,

Key findings:

- At large n , the algorithm gives the direct
- At small n , the algorithm gives a reasona
- As a pattern matching method, the algori

Future work:

- Developing methods to take advantage c
- Investigating how to apply to monolithic
- Investigating a generalized approach to t



gs, and Future Work

rection of antineutrino sources

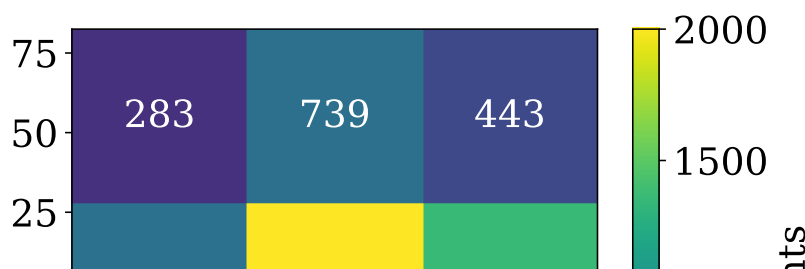
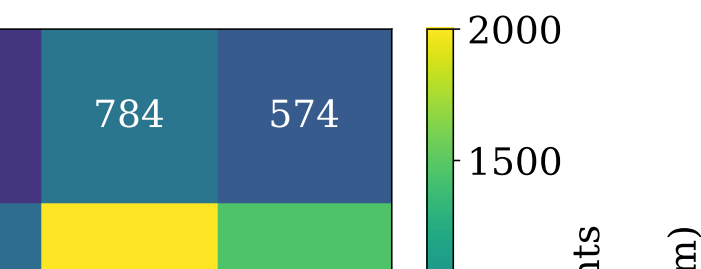
onable uncertainty

gorithm provides a comparison between distributions

ge of machine learning

chic detectors

to three dimensionally segmented detectors



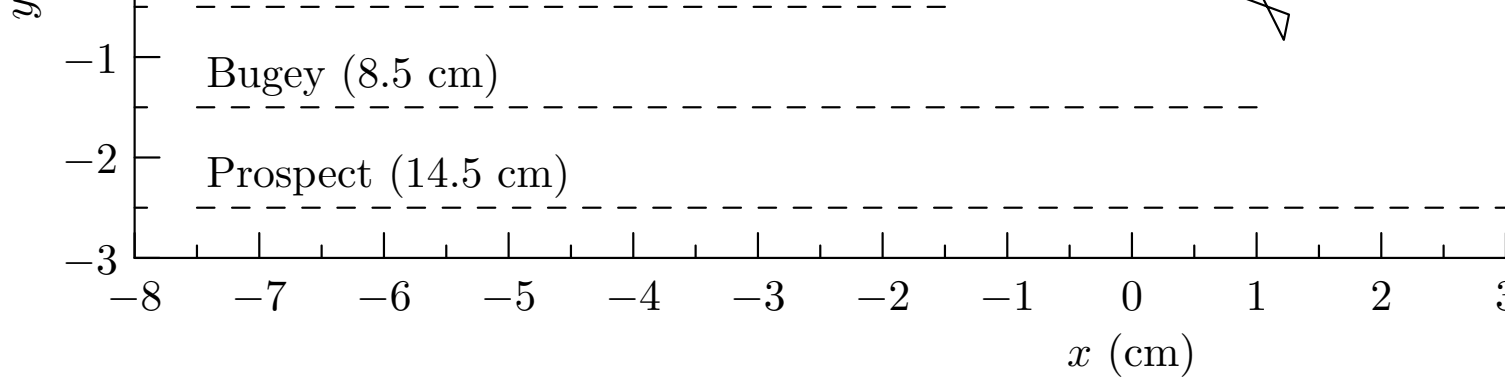
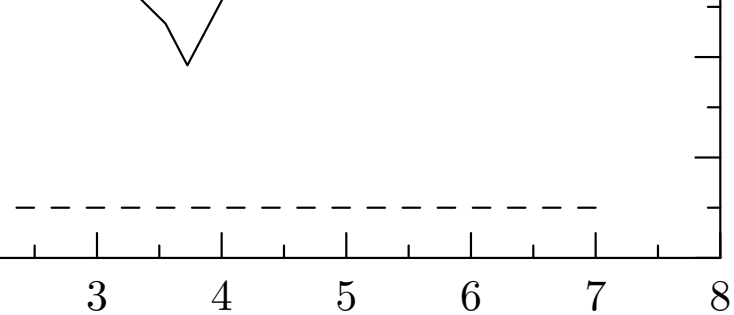


Figure 1: Diagram showcasing relative scale for characteristic neutrino IBD vertex to capture location, as well as dimensions of segments SANDD, MAD, Bugey, and PROSPECT.

Traditional Approach

- Conventional uncertainty calculation:

$$\Delta_{\text{uncertainty}} \left(\frac{P}{l} \right)$$

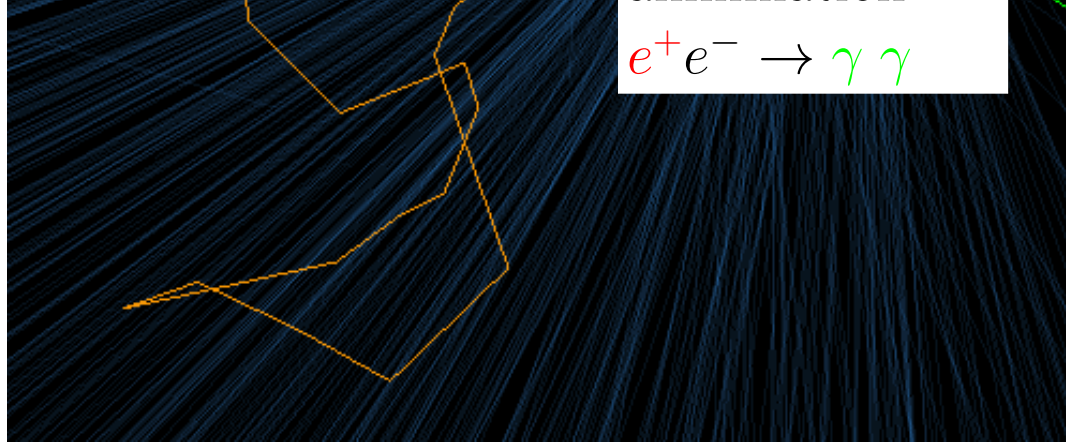


neutron xy -trajectory projection from
 ents in four 2D-segmented detectors:

Figure 3: Rendering of RA
 gamma-rays — green, Ch
 Cherenkov photons indica
 bottom left in this perspe

Novel Algor

- Generate reference
 This is done by rot
 the binning descri

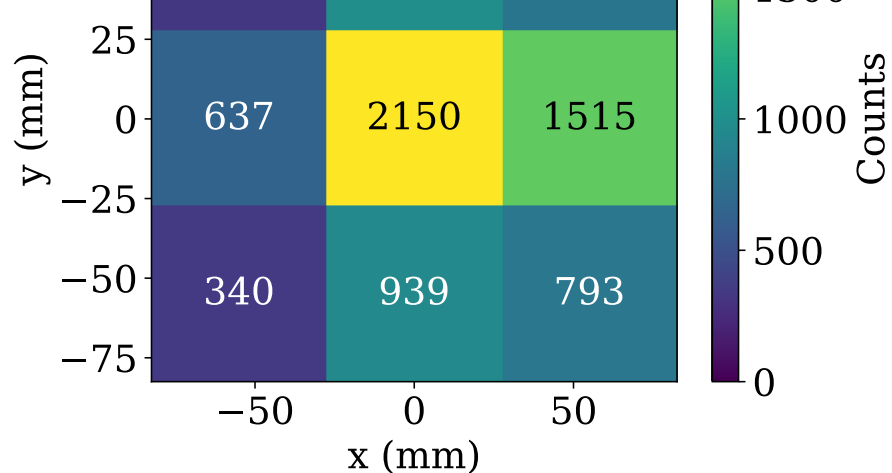


RAT-PAC 2 IBD visualization. Positron track in red, neutron track — Cherenkov photons — cyan. Scintillation light turned off for clarity. Indicate the direction of the positron, which traveled from the top right perspective (neutrino, not shown, is from top right to bottom left).

Algorithm for Segmented Detectors

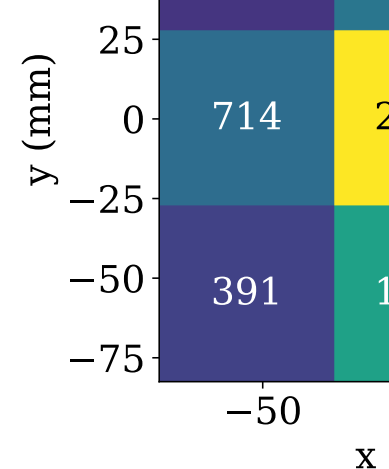
ence data for all incident angles

rotating the grid overlay on simulation data and then performing
described below



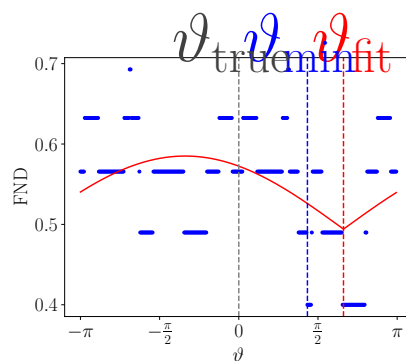
→

$$\vartheta_\nu = 0^\circ$$

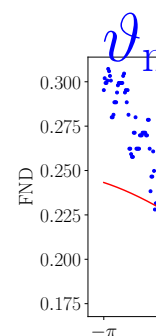


$$\vartheta_\nu$$

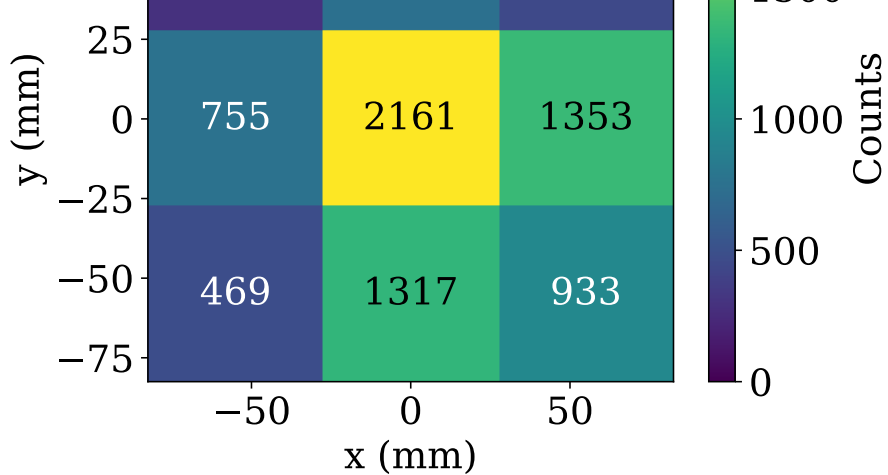
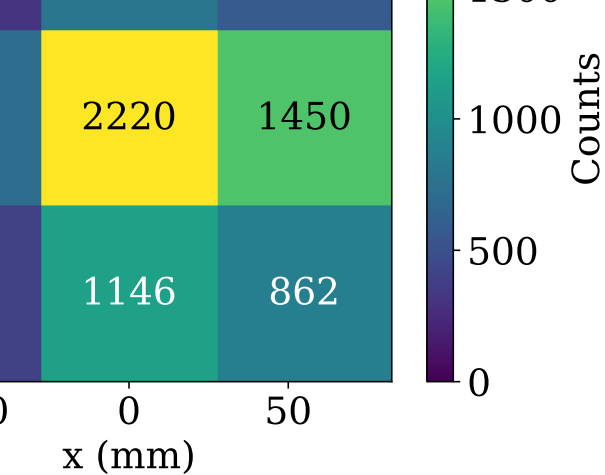
Figure 5: Examples of binning distributions for incorrect direction of antineutrinos is indicated by the arrows



(a) $n = 10$



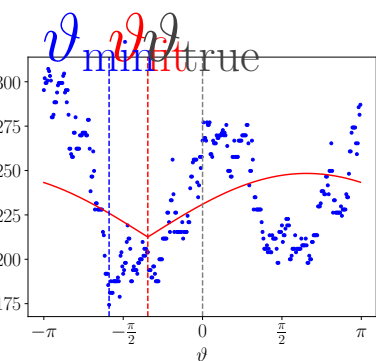
(b)



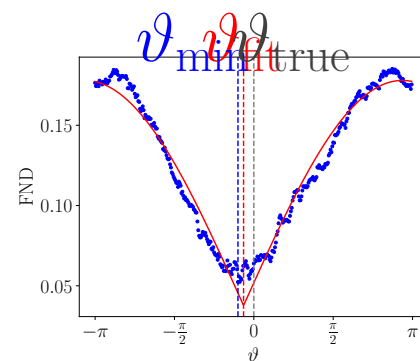
$$\vartheta_\nu = -30^\circ$$

$$\vartheta_\nu = -45^\circ$$

incoming angles $\vartheta_\nu = 0^\circ, -30^\circ, -45^\circ$, 0.1% ^6Li -doped. The rows below the plots.



b) $n = 100$



(c) $n = 1000$

$$\Delta\varphi = \arctan\left(\frac{P/l}{\sqrt{N}}\right)$$

- If mean position resolution $P \rightarrow 0$, angular uncertainty $\rightarrow 0$
- Vogel and Beacom model shows a large spread ($\sim 20^\circ$)
- Neutrons scatter many times before capture

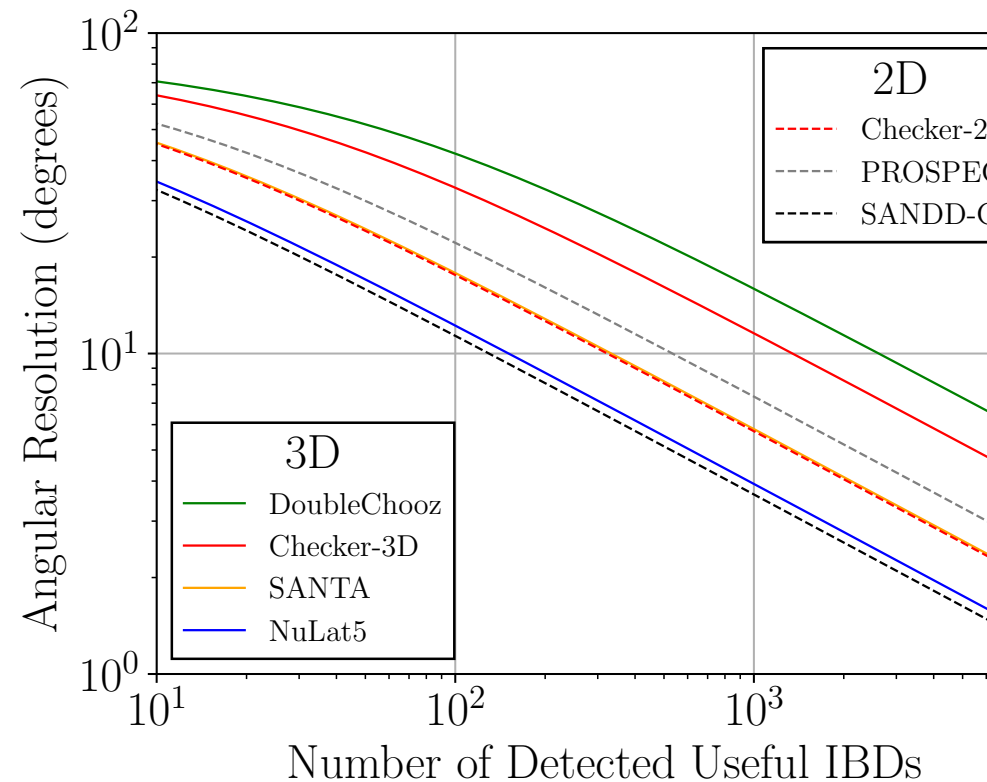
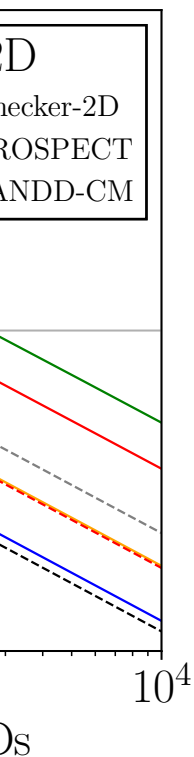


Figure 2: Angular uncertainty calculated using the conventional “

$$\left. \begin{pmatrix} \vdots \\ \vdots \end{pmatrix} \right) \quad (1)$$

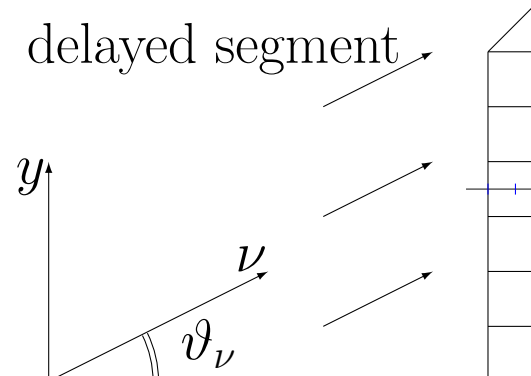
uncertainty $\Delta\varphi \rightarrow 0$ – unphysical!
 $\sim 26^\circ$) in initial neutron direction



al “Chooz” approach. A selected

- the binning description
- Bin prompt and delayed segments
number of voxels
all matrices for ref
- Create binning matrix
- Compute the L^2 norm
- Fit $\alpha \left| \sin \left(\frac{\theta - \theta_0}{2} \right) \right|$ to
parameter for the

■ prompt segment
 ■ delayed segment



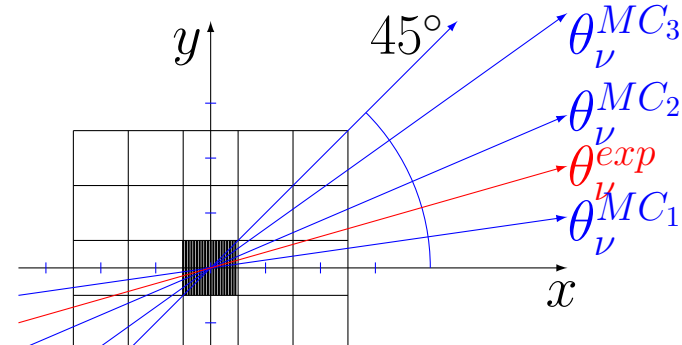
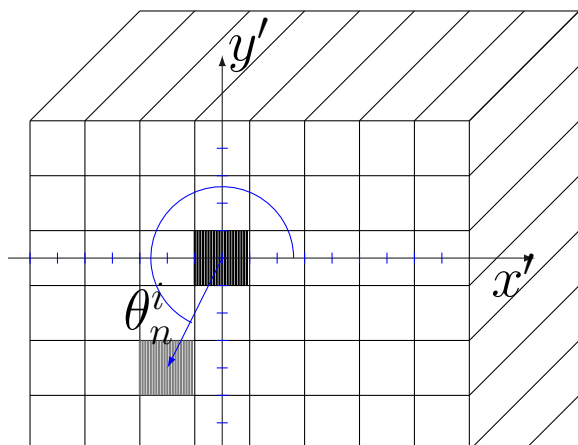
described below

and delayed displacement vectors in matrix form by counting
 cells separating the IBD vertex and the capture vertex. Normalized
 reference angles

matrix for data set and normalize it

L^2 norm for the matrix differences for all reference angles

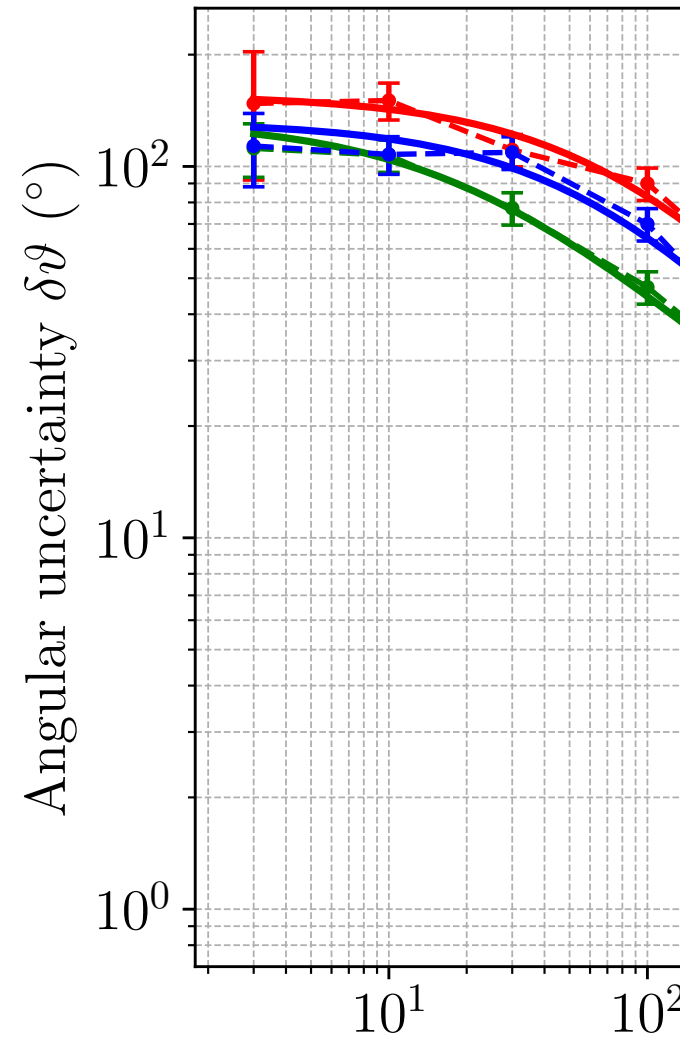
to L^2 norms as a function of angle. The minimum gives the
 the direction of the neutrino source.



(a) $n = 10$

(b)

Figure 6: Explanation of angles and spread. The FNN data with a segment size of 50 mm.



b) $n = 100$ (c) $n = 1000$

FND here is calculated from the RATPAC2 neutron capture

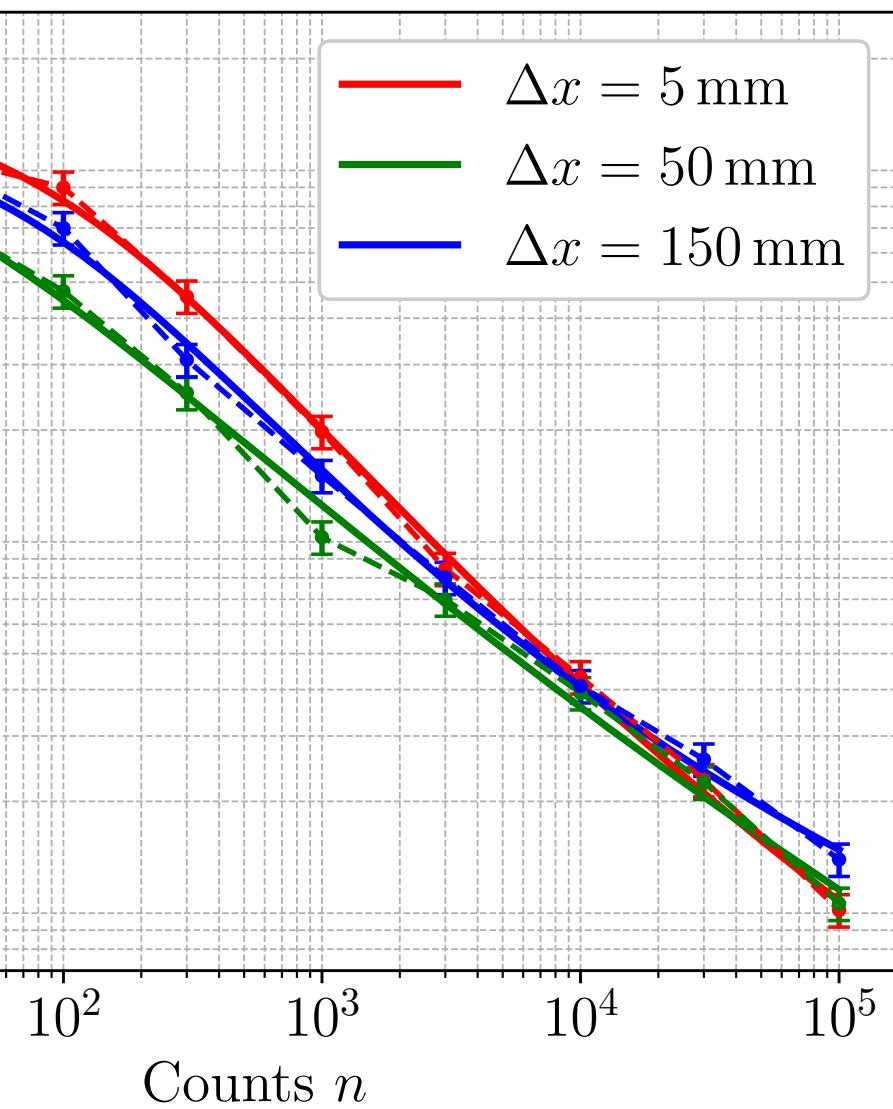


Figure 2: Angular uncertainty calculated using the conventional “number of segmented detectors along with Chooz is highlighted. We have prompt and delayed signals in separate segments. This result is under study [?].

References

- [1] Crow *et al.*, in prep. (2026)
- [2] Duvall *et al.*, Phys. Rev. Applied **22**, 054030 (2024)

al “Chooz” approach. A selected
ed. Useful IBD events are those that
result is taken from our previous

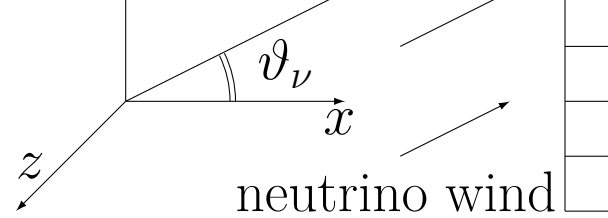
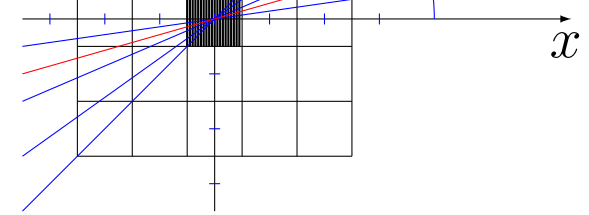
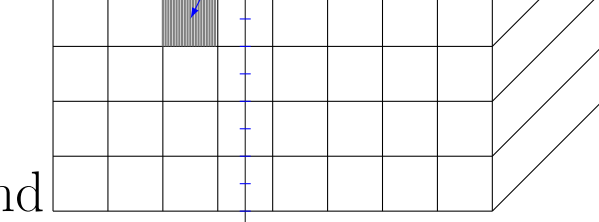


Figure 4: Diagram explaining
orientation.



nd

obtaining the prompt-delayed segment geometry, as well as neutrino and

Acknowledgments

This work was funded in-part by the
Administration award number DE-NA

and axes

Figure 7: Angular uncertainty plot comparing the pe
50 mm and 150 mm.

10^{-1} 10^{-2} 10^{-3} 10^{-4}
Counts n

the performance of three different square segment sizes: 5 mm,

Department of Energy National Nuclear Security
POST-XXXXXX.

Ref. [1]:

